

Installing EpisodeSleuth on Windows

This guide covers installing **EpisodeSleuth** (the phonetic dialogue fingerprinting system) on a Windows machine. No programming experience required.

There are two ways to install, from easiest to most involved:

Option	Best for	Needs Python?
A. Standalone package (recommended)	Just running the app	No
B. Source install (in-stall.bat)	Developers, or running from source	Yes

The only external tool the standalone app still needs at run time is **FFmpeg** (for decoding audio). Installing it is one command - see below.

Option A: Standalone package (recommended, no Python)

This is the simplest path. You get a self-contained app - no Python, no `pip`, no virtual environment.

1. Get **EpisodeSleuth-<version>-windows-x64.zip** (from the project's Releases, or build it yourself with `package_windows.ps1` - see [BUILD_EXECUTABLES.md](#)).
2. **Right-click the .zip -> Extract All...** to a folder of your choice.
3. Open the extracted folder. You now have two choices:
 - **Just run it:** open the `EpisodeSleuth` folder and double-click `EpisodeSleuth.exe`. That's it.
 - **Install with shortcuts:** double-click `Install-EpisodeSleuth.bat`. Run it normally to install for the current user, or right-click -> **Run as administrator** to install for all users. It copies the app into Program Files (or your user folder) and creates Desktop + Start-menu shortcuts.
4. Install **FFmpeg** (needed to decode audio):
`winget install Gyan.FFmpeg`
5. On first launch, open the app's **Settings** page and download the offline speech model (unless your package already bundles it).

SmartScreen warning? Because the app is not code-signed, Windows may show “Windows protected your PC”. Click **More info -> Run anyway**. This is expected for unsigned apps and is safe for a build you trust. See [BUILD_EXECUTABLES.md](#) for notes on signing.

To uninstall a shortcut install:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\Install-EpisodeSleuth.ps1 -Uninstall
```

Option B: Source install (developers)

Use this if you want to run from source with your own Python, or you are developing EpisodeSleuth.

What you need

Component	Why	Install method
Python 3.10+	Runs all the scripts	<code>winget install Python.Python.3.12</code> or python.org
FFmpeg	Decodes video/audio so the STT engine can process it	<code>winget install Gyan.FFmpeg</code> or ffmpeg.org
Vosk speech model	Offline speech-to-text engine (phonetic matching)	Downloaded automatically by <code>install.ps1</code>
Python packages	PySide6-Fluent-Widgets, Vosk, metaphone, etc.	<code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code>

B1: Automatic

1. Open the project folder in File Explorer.
2. **Double-click** `install.bat`.
3. Follow any prompts (it may ask to install Python or FFmpeg via `winget`).
4. When it says “Setup complete”, you are done. A Desktop shortcut (“EpisodeSleuth”) will have been created.

From PowerShell you can also run:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\install.ps1
```

Useful flags:

Flag	Effect
-NoVenv	Install Python packages into the system Python instead of a <code>.venv</code>
-NoModel	Skip the Vosk model download
-NoShortcut	Do not create Desktop / Start-menu shortcuts
-Force	Reinstall packages and re-download the model even if present

B2: Manual step-by-step

1. Install Python 3

Download from python.org (tick “Add Python to PATH” during install), or via winget:

```
winget install Python.Python.3.12
```

Verify:

```
python --version
```

2. Install FFmpeg

FFmpeg is needed to decode audio from video files so the speech-to-text engine can process it.

```
winget install Gyan.FFmpeg
```

Or download manually from ffmpeg.org, extract, and add the `bin\` folder to your system PATH.

Verify:

```
ffmpeg -version
```

3. Install Python packages

From the project folder:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

This installs PySide6-Fluent-Widgets (the GUI toolkit), Vosk (speech-to-text), Double Metaphone (phonetic encoding), and other dependencies.

4. Download the Vosk speech model

The offline speech-to-text engine needs a language model. Download and extract the small English model:

1. Download: <https://alphacephei.com/vosk/models/vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15.zip>
2. Extract the zip so you get a folder `vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15`
3. Move that folder into the project's `models\` directory:

```
models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\
```

(`install.ps1` does this automatically.)

Running the app

- **Standalone (Option A):** double-click the **EpisodeSleuth** shortcut, or `EpisodeSleuth.exe` inside the app folder.
- **Source install (Option B) - GUI:** double-click the **EpisodeSleuth** shortcut, or run `python -m audio_fingerprint.gui`
- **Source install (Option B) - CLI:**
`python -m audio_fingerprint.cli.identify --dir "C:\path\to\dvd_rips"`

See [README.md](#) and [USAGE_DVD.md](#) for full usage.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
SmartScreen blocks the app	Click "More info" -> "Run anyway" (unsigned build)
<code>ffmpeg</code> not found	Run <code>winget install Gyan.FFmpeg</code> , then open a new terminal (PATH refresh)
Vosk model errors	Open Settings and download the model, or check <code>models\vosk-model-small-en-us-0.15\</code> exists
"speech-to-text module could not be loaded"	Standalone: re-download the package (older builds missed the STT deps); Source: run <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code> again
<code>python</code> not found (source install)	Make sure "Add Python to PATH" was ticked during install, or open a new terminal
GUI won't start (source install)	Run <code>pip install -r requirements.txt</code> again to ensure PySide6-Fluent-Widgets is installed